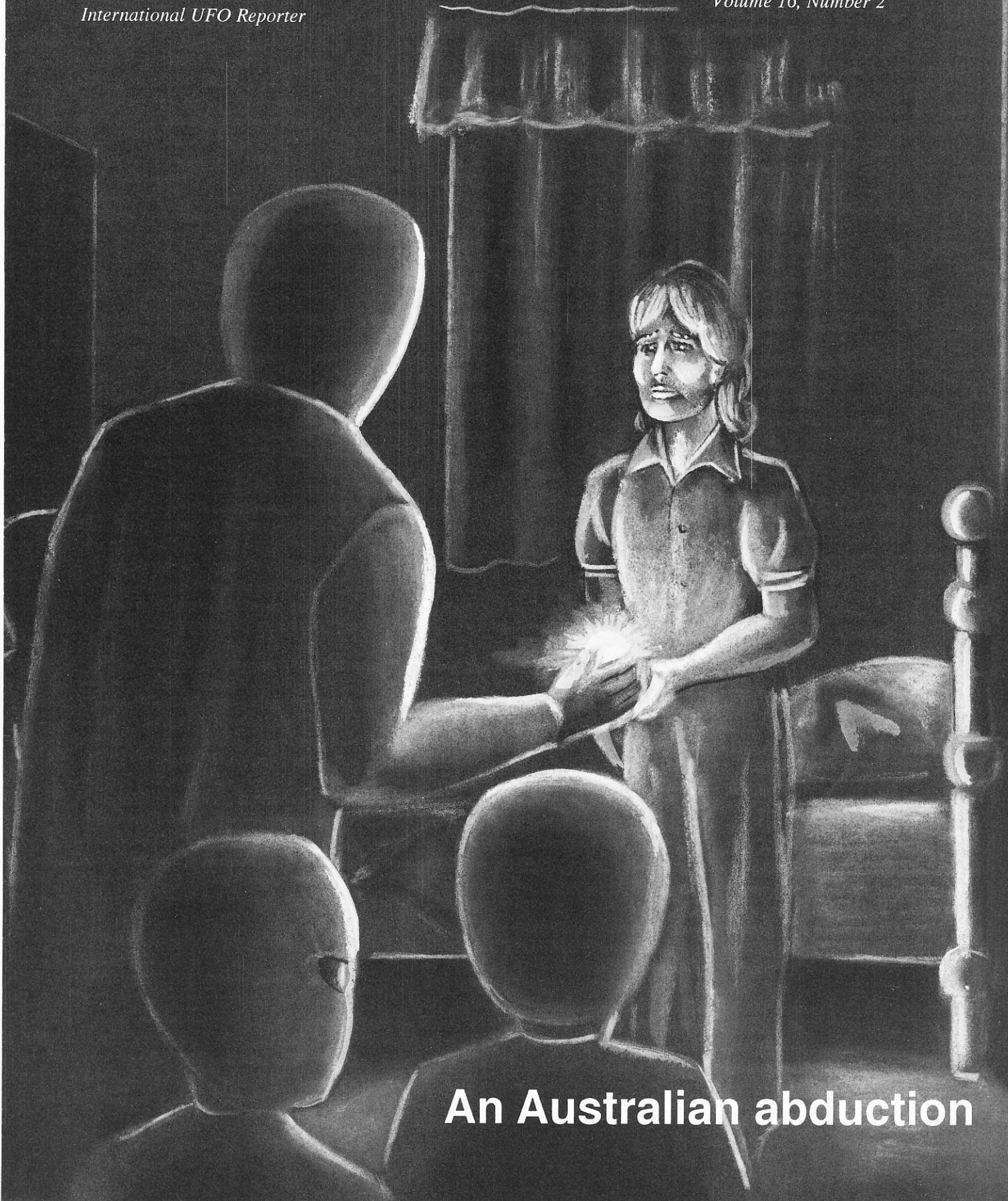


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An Australian abduction

INTERNATIONAL UFO REPORTER

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Trivial pursuit

For all of ufology's history ufologists have sought, on one hand, to investigate and document reports and, on the other, to counter those forces that would trivialize the subject. Since 1947 we have seen the UFO phenomenon trivialized by authority-figure bigots, who misrepresent the evidence (if they understand what it is at all) so that they can belittle it, by supermarket tabloids (the words "UFO" and *National Enquirer* now seem inextricably linked), and by pop culture's smarmy minions. Worst of all, the phenomenon has been trivialized by those who are supposed to be its friends.

As ufology's serious proponents have argued the case for scientific UFO study, they have also had to do battle with naive flying-saucer fans whose critical sense seems as limited as their credulity is boundless. In the 1950s the field's elite figures were bedeviled by contactees and their followers, who threatened to turn UFO research into a new science-fiction/occult faith—a faith that, perhaps not so incidentally, had nothing to do with, even actively contradicted, what real evidence was telling us about the nature of the UFO phenomenon (not to mention, of course, what astronomy was telling us about the probability of advanced human civilizations on Venus and Mars). If the many questions surrounding UFO sightings were to be answered, the serious proponents insisted, those answers would have to be based on properly documented information gleaned from careful investigation and exacting analysis.

Of course such was, and remains, easier said than done. The cerebral level of most ufological discourse is not staggeringly high, and often enough even basic common sense is an elusive presence, if that, in the ruminations of ufology's intellectually helpless. (At the same time, fairness demands this parenthetical insertion: as I know from reading my *IUR* mail, ufology's ranks also contain good, smart people whose ties with consensus reality are firm and unshakable. Unfortunately, these usually aren't the people who attract all the attention, probably because, unlike the headline-hustlers, they don't demand it.) In recent years lunatic tales of man-eating aliens, sinister U.S. government/ET conspiracies, slave colonies on Mars, and other delirious dementia have been widely accepted by wide-eyed acceptors who, possibly because they don't read the newspapers, don't find the real world sufficiently terrifying.

My point here, however, is not to belabor the obvious



Jerome Clark

point that credulity is an obstacle to understanding the UFO phenomenon. Because ours is a free country and because "ufologist" is an identification anyone can claim, we are always going to be stuck with naive individuals and movements, and all we can do is distance ourselves from them and make clear our own very different priorities. It is those priorities, and the strange state in which we find them now, that I wish to address here.

In this space in the last issue of *IUR*, CUFO's scientific director Mark Rodeghier, echoing the refrain of an old Rolling Stones song, remarked, "You can't always get what you want." All too true; but what if it happens that you do get what you want, and you refuse it, having decided somewhere between the wish and the fulfillment that you would settle for something much less?

There was a time, not all that long ago, when ufologists heaped scorn on scientists, academics, and debunkers who would apply patently inadequate "explanations" to UFO experiences. As Allen Hynek once had occasion to observe, thinking of Donald Menzel, Carl Sagan, and others, "Science is not always what scientists do." Behavioral scientist David J. Hufford has written that academics tend to forget all of their academic training in their haste to transform extraordinary experiences into ordinary misperceptions, even if that means ignoring what people say happened to them so radically as to substitute an invented experience for the real one. The result is an explanation for something that took place only in the explainer's imagination.

As neoskepticism, in the form of interpretive frameworks grounded in often airy psychosocial and geophysical speculations, has taken hold as a major force in world ufology, these sorts of abuses of evidence and logic have become distressingly ubiquitous. Not only that, the neoskeptics pride themselves on their wholesale dismissal of witnesses' testimony, which they declare irrelevant for an obvious reason: it is incompatible with what they want UFO experiences to be.

No "natural" explanation for UFO sightings, for example, convincingly accounts for the many thousands of reports of structured, metallic, craftlike objects, or the

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An Australian abduction

by Keith Basterfield

■ ■ Keith Basterfield, one of Australia's leading ufologists, is a regular contributor to *IUR*.

In an earlier *IUR* article ("Australian Abductions: An Update," May/June 1990), Vladimir Godic, Pony Godic, and I drew attention to the growing number of abduction accounts surfacing in Australia.

During March 1990 a member of UFO Research South Australia (UFORSA) told me he had met a woman who had apparently undergone an abduction. UFORSA requested my assistance, and so I telephoned her and arranged to interview her. I shall call her Susan, though that is not her real name.

Since then I have spent a number of hours talking with her, her husband, her children, her sister, and others who know her. This article details the story that has emerged and considers various theoretical interpretations.

The percipient — 1

Susan, 31, has been married for 10 years to David and has two daughters aged seven and nine. She has a younger sister, Rachael, and two brothers, Tim and Mark. Both her parents are still alive. Susan and David live in an outer suburb of Adelaide, the capital of the state of South Australia. Both are employed as nursing aides at a residential care complex in the city.

The family changed houses a number of times in Susan's early childhood, moving between various states within Australia because of the father's occupation.

David and Susan have been living at their current address for six years. Lately David has turned his talents toward a singing career, while Susan has become interested in New Age philosophy, including channeling.

Conscious recollections

At the first interview Susan told me she could recall two specific incidents from her childhood:

(1) In 1967 or 1968, when she was eight or nine, the family was living near Port Augusta in South Australia. She was with a group of children walking to a local garage when a group of unusual lights approached the young people. Some of the lights were white, others red or green. The children hid in a ditch along the road as six

lights hovered over them. Susan has a fragmentary memory of the children's running across a field and of her trying to wake up the other children. She is unable to recall the names of any of the children.

(2) At age 10 or 11, in about 1969 or 1970, the family moved to Adelaide. One night she was so certain that "they" were coming to get her that she persuaded her sister to swap beds with her. Later that night, with both sisters in bed, some little beings, accompanied by a taller entity, entered the bedroom and abducted her. She was taken to a "room" where a medical examination ensued, followed by a educative film and discussion session. Details of this episode began to emerge the next morning and continued to do so in a long series of nightmares which continued until she was 20 years old.

The story emerges

With the two initial recollections documented, Susan wished to undergo a regression/relaxation session to determine if she could recall any further details of the two experiences, particularly the abduction at 10 or 11. This was arranged, and three sessions were conducted using the three-stage technique proposed by Richard F. Haines in *Journal of UFO Studies* (1989). Susan proved an excellent regression subject, going easily back to the earlier age, and additional memories surfaced.

As the account went, Susan and her sister were sleeping in the same bedroom, having exchanged beds. With the room light off, the girls settled down to sleep. Then she felt "warm and expanded," and a high-pitched ringing sound came up the hallway. A number of beings came into the room and acted confused not to find Susan in her bed. But soon they came to the bed where she lay. She saw a number of small beings and one tall one. Using telepathy, the tall one urged her not to be afraid and to go with them. Susan was levitated from the bed and placed on the floor. The beings handed her a small "ball of light," then surrounded her. Then the group walked through the wall and out into the yard.

The beings and Susan proceeded up into the sky on "invisible steps." Above them was a brilliant light which surrounded them. Suddenly there were all in a "room." The ball was removed from the girl's hands, and she was taken to a hard chair, where she sat down. This chair was then turned into a horizontal "table." The tall entity conducted a medical examination, during which he

probed her vagina. Susan felt the being looked worried about something. Another tall entity entered her view, and together the tall ones brought up what looked like a "table with big sides." Susan lost consciousness.

Next she was aware of waking up. She felt sick. The small beings sat her up and gave her a warm, purple-colored drink. She was bathed in a green light. Her legs felt like jelly, and the small beings walked her around until feeling returned to her legs.

Then she was taken over to a pile of cushions on the floor. After she sat down with the small beings beside her, a device in the wall started up and pictures formed and ran like a movie. This movie showed a planet in space and a city with close-ups of trees, parks, and people. The people were of the same type as the tall beings involved in the abduction.

Some form of disaster, possibly an earthquake, occurred, and people were shown dying. What appeared to be a spacecraft took off with survivors. The tall being with Susan told her he was a descendant of the survivors and that his people used to live on the earth. He said they are a form of interdimensional being.

Susan was then informed she must go back because she will be important in some way when she grows up. The ball of light was handed back to her to hold, and she was taken back to bed by the reverse of the method by which she entered the room.

At the end of the third session Susan was asked if she had ever met the entities any other time since the just-described episode. She replied that she had had the experience on other occasions. We did not explore these through regression because I wanted to see what would be recalled spontaneously.

She remembered an abduction at age 12 from a beach, one at 16 or 17 when she was taken to what she took to be a planet, and an abduction from a town house when she was 19. Asked to describe the beings involved, she said that the smaller beings were about four feet tall. Their hairless heads were abnormally large for the size of their bodies. They were wearing flesh-colored, one-piece outfits. They had large eye sockets, with no pupils visible. The eyes were dark-colored, blue or black. They had a slit mouth and a small nose. The cheeks were bony and they had webbing between their fingers. The taller beings seemed to be in command. They were some seven feet tall and of moderate build. They wore something like a suit and cape with a hood over the head. They were male and had normal noses. They avoided the light and communicated with the smaller beings by hand signals and looks, and possibly by telepathy.

Visitations continue to occur, part of what seems to be a life-long interaction with the entities.

Sexual aspects

Most if not all of her abduction accounts include some form of medical examination, specifically a gynecologi-

cal exam. In addition to this, from the age of 14, the interactions with the tall aliens included sexual intercourse initiated by the aliens. Susan says they have been collecting "fluid" and "messing around with my ovaries." In this regard, Susan claims, she underwent two anomalous pregnancies.

(1) Around 1979 she thought she was pregnant, but there was no sign of this condition in either blood or urine samples. She experienced cravings and had an enlarged stomach. Her period ceased and her breasts became tender. One month later, as she was going to the toilet, "this little thing came away." Everything then returned to normal.

(2) After one of the alien sex sessions in 1986, she went to a doctor, who diagnosed her as pregnant. She had not had sex with David or any other human being. She then started having nightmares of being pregnant with a nonhuman baby. She became seriously ill. The doctor affirmed that she was pregnant but that the baby was not moving. He believed it had died. Later Susan had a black discharge—an apparent spontaneous abortion.

Implants

When 20 years old, Susan went to a dentist who asked her if she had any previous dental work on her upper gums. She said she had not and was told that x-rays revealed two unusual objects in her upper gums. The dental work was undertaken at a public hospital. A recent written request to locate and secure these x-rays elicited the response that records are kept only for seven years and then destroyed.

The percipient — 2

Besides the above phenomena Susan claimed a number of paranormal experiences. A partial catalog follows:

(1) As a child she often heard "footsteps" when no one was physically present.

(2) In 1979, when she married David, they would have occasional fights or disagreements. Sometimes during these episodes if he went to get a drink of water, the glass would shatter. Knives would fly out of a drawer and point at him.

(3) In one house she lived in, she sensed a "presence."

(4) Tapping noises emanated from the ceiling and would go on all day. Both David and Susan heard these.

(5) She once slept levitated above her bed.

(6) When children she and a brother sometimes slept with their eyes open.

(7) The kids' bikes would run around by themselves.

(8) Strange noises, resembling the sound of two pieces of concrete rubbing against each other, were heard.

(9) At work chairs moved themselves. An invisible force pulled Susan's hair. Footsteps would chase nurses, and apparitions were seen.

(10) As she watched television, a "vision" would cover the images on the screen. This vision, reminiscent of a newscast, would come true within a few weeks.

(11) One of her wedding photographs depicted her grandfather, who had died two years earlier.

(12) Unusual calming "music" appeared from nowhere at times.

Susan said that these phenomena often occurred when she was angry or distressed.

The percipient — 3

Besides a life-long interaction with the aliens, Susan also was sexually abused within her family from an early age. The abuse stopped when she was 18, but it left a deep mark on her behavior as an adult survivor of child sexual abuse. Susan recently underwent 12 months of extensive professional therapy to deal with her anger over the issue. Susan remarked that there is some confusion in her mind about which memories belong to the abuse situation and which to the abductions.

The percipient — 4

Susan possesses powerful imagery skills. She experiences frequent hypnagogic/hypnopompic imagery. She also can close her eyes and retain a colored, three-dimensional image of the scene she last saw before closing her eyes and retain that image for a while; this phenomenon, known as eidetic imagery, is a skill many children have but usually lose before they reach adulthood. She becomes absorbed in activities to the exclusion of other stimuli. She can enter a trance state at will. Her sleep patterns are unusual—she sleeps very little at all.

Rachael's memories

When I interviewed her, Rachael could vividly recall the night when Susan requested the bed-swap. Such a switch was most unusual, but Rachael agreed. She saw a ball of light come down the passageway outside the bedroom and then enter the room. She ducked under the blankets and can remember nothing else of that night.

Discussion

In this case study we have four threads to follow. First, there are memories of a life-long interaction with aliens, including sexual relations. Second, there is a life-long series of paranormal events. Third, for the first 18 years of her life she suffered sexual abuse, the memories of which she lived with until she was 30, at which time she sought professional assistance. Fourth, there is her account of "implants."

Readers familiar with the abduction literature will recognize many aspects of Susan's story. In *Intruders*

(1987) Budd Hopkins brought anomalous pregnancies to our attention. Joseph Nyman, in an article in the *MUFON UFO Journal* (March 1989), described the latent entity—a life-long "friend" of an abductee. Rima E. Laibow (*IUR*, May/June 1989) examined abductions and child abuse. Implants are discussed in writings by Hopkins, Whitley Strieber, and Thomas E. Bullard.

Three hypotheses to explain the abduction phenomenon still stand. These are the genetic experimentation by extraterrestrials (Hopkins and others), D. Scott Rogo's "objectified dream" idea (*IUR*, July/August 1987), and fantasy-prone personality (proposed by Robert E. Bartholomew and me; see *IUR*, May/June 1988). How does this particular case fit these?

Rogo once wrote that during a discussion with Hopkins about the merits of Rogo's theory "I agreed that childhood abductions and life-long contact experiences . . . were inconsistent with my own theory." Thus his "objectified dream" can be ruled out in this particular case.

Second, the multiple abductions, the aliens' interest in the gynecological aspects of Susan, the two unusual pregnancies, and the alleged implants certainly fit the hypothesis of genetic experimentation by extraterrestrials. But the major proponent of this hypothesis, Hopkins, has not addressed the issue of the association of paranormal episodes and abductions—an association noted or claimed by Jenny Randles, Jacques Vallee, and Bullard, among others. The extraterrestrial hypothesis does not seem capable of explaining why an abduction should occur to an individual who has experienced sexual abuse as a child and who has had, and continues to have, excellent imagery skills, unless other than by chance.

How about the fantasy-prone-personality hypothesis? What of the pregnancies? The chief proponents of the FPP hypothesis are Sheryl Wilson and T. X. Barber, who remark on the high rate of phantom pregnancies in their group of FPP individuals. These women believed they were pregnant; menstruation ceased; there were breast changes, abdominal enlargement, and apparent fetal movements. Wilson and Barber add, "Two of the subjects went for abortions, following which they were told that no fetus had been found." Some ufologists may argue that these two women were in fact abductees.

What of the life-long nature of the claims? It is significant that the child abuse was also from an early age to age 18. It might be argued that just as multiple personalities are created by traumatic incidents in childhood, often abuse situations, so Susan may have escaped into a world of fantasy using her excellent imagery skills. Once she had established this alternate reality, it continued into her adult life. Not until she was 30 did she ever face the results of the abuse on her personality and behavior.

What of the paranormal episodes? Wilson and Barber associate paranormal episodes with fantasy. Were the reported episodes of sexual intercourse also fantasies? Wilson and Barber say many of their FPP subjects could

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I remember Blue Book

by Jennie Zeidman

■ ■ Jennie Zeidman, author of *A Helicopter-UFO Encounter Over Ohio* (1979), is a CUFOS board member and a contributing editor to *IUR*.

The dark recesses of the CUFOS archives have yielded up a paper titled *Report to Stork on Blue Book Henry*. The by-line is my own; the date is August 1953.

The document is a compendium of 148 "FLYOB-RPTS" (flying object reports) and their cursory analyses as they passed from the Air Technical Intelligence Center (ATIC) through the hands of J. Allen Hynek (and me) between January and July 1953. (See illustrations 1 and 2 for examples.) The report also summarizes correspondence with the 35 amateur astronomical societies, 19 Ground Observer Corps Filter Centers, and 48 CAA (now FAA) Control Towers which were contacted with the objective that they would or could provide corroborating (or disconfirming) information for the official reports, specifically with regard to phenomena such as bright meteors/fireballs, normal aircraft, or meteorological phenomena.

The report itself is of little import. The Air Force favored astronomical answers, and Hynek was able to provide many from the selected raw reports presented for his analysis. (See bar graph.) The extremely high number of unknowns (22 percent) and cases of insufficient data (another 10.8 percent) reflect not so much the high strangeness of the information presented as the inadequacy of the reporting mechanism. One paragraph of teletyped tidbits was supposed to provide enough information for a justified, probable, or at least possible identification. Of course it couldn't be done. I don't recall our criteria for differentiation between "unknowns" and "insufficient data." The only certainty I can see in perusing this report is that Venus was in eastern elongation during that time period and that lots of people, even those from college physics departments, couldn't identify it.

Of greater interest than the report may be some associated memories of those heady times: the convolutions of funding of UFO research, the desperate emphasis on hush-hush amid an environment of ludicrously slipshod security, and the unfolding mystery of where Hynek's consultancy to the Air Force on Project Blue

Book really fit into the larger scheme of the UFO hierarchy. Enlightening discussions of these matters appear in Hynek's *The Hynek UFO Report* (1977) and David M. Jacobs' *The UFO Controversy in America* (1975). The remarks that follow reflect my personal involvement and interpretations as Hynek's assistant between 1953 and 1956.

Project Stork

Let us start with Project Stork. I doubt, 38 years later, that I'll ruffle any feathers with that name. Heaven knows, it's been mentioned in print, and from time to time I've come across persons (there must have been thousands of us, worldwide) who worked on various phases of it. The fact is that the mission of Stork was to ascertain the capability of the Soviet Union to engage in technological warfare. The specific interest for our purpose is that the group at Battelle Memorial Institute which produced the (in)famous *Project Blue Book Special Report 14* was associated with Project Stork. Okay, let's not beat around the bush. *Special Report 14* was a product of Project Stork.

Does that mean that the government thought UFOs might be Soviet technology? Or does it mean that the government already knew (five years after the Roswell incident) what UFOs represented, wanted to see what the Stork statisticians came up with, and then made sure that the "analysis" met with government "standards"? (Shades of the Condon Committee 15 years later.)

The answer is: probably not. The Condon Committee's blatant objective was to pacify the public, whereas *Special Report 14*, within Battelle/Stork, was Top Secret. It didn't *need* to be created (for public consumption) if the answer was already known—in other words, that the empirical characteristics of UFO reports were statistically different from those of reports that were ultimately resolved into mundane phenomena. Or was Stork perhaps merely a convenient funding vehicle for *14*, a legitimately asked question, a relatively small effort that could be justified (or hidden) under the scope of the Stork mission? Regardless, Battelle was the right place for the work to be done. It is a superb group of scientists and engineers scrupulously devoted to excellence.

Battelle's involvement with the fringe subject of UFOs was therefore a source of great embarrassment to it—a family secret, a skeleton in the closet equivalent to

Grandpa's alcoholism or Uncle Ray's penchant for little boys. One absolutely did not mention Battelle in connection with UFOs. And since I had no need to know, the fact of this involvement (in spite of my Secret clearance) was kept from me for over a year.

In the spring of 1987 I found myself at a dinner party seated next to a Battelle executive—an old timer who I knew had worked on 14 as a member of Project Stork. I asked him if after 34 years he had anything he wanted to say about it.

My question made him uneasy. "We were concerned," he said. He was referring to the data and to the Battelle scientists' interpretation of those data. He was referring to the thoughts of his fellow scientists on the question of "What are UFOs?" "We were concerned," he said, and he would say no more.

Project Henry

During the first month (January 1953) I worked for him, Hynek went to Washington to attend the meeting of the Robertson Panel. He was an associate member, a second stringer, which was odd because he had been working directly with the data for about five years. I remember his return on a cold, wintry day. I expected him to announce there would be a major scientific undertaking on the subject. Instead, he told me, "They're not going to have a scientific investigation. For some strange reason they voted it down. They didn't even take a decent look at the data, and they decided to discredit them."

Perhaps he needed some levity that day when he looked up from his coffee and crackers and suggested that we should have a name for his consultancy project, "something that captures the idea that these things flit around the sky." An old-time popular insecticide was called Flit, and its trademark showed a hand-pumped sprayer and, I believe, a harried woman who had just been scared by a bug. "Quick, Henry, the Flit!" she is shouting. Hynek latched on to the word Flit, and thus Project Henry was named (Flit being too obvious and Project Insecticide somewhat cumbersome). Readers familiar with Hynek's sense of humor know I couldn't possibly have made this up.

This is the way Henry worked:

About once a week a courier from Wright-Patterson Air Force Base (I assumed he was from Wright-Patterson) would arrive at Hynek's office at Ohio State University with a manila envelope stuffed with TWXs—teletype UFO-sighting reports received from military facilities around the world.

Were they all of the reports Blue Book received—the total number it took in? Surely not. (Hynek often said he knew the best cases were withheld.) I usually looked them over before Hynek did. I had a Secret clearance by then (mid-1953), but only a few were ever classified beyond Restricted, and the sensitive material usually had to do with the installation or facility of report origin, not

with the contents of the report per se. If Venus was in western elongation, there would be a whole slew of reports of a bright white light in the predawn east, and Hynek would chuckle and mutter about how darned uneducated the public was. When we would get a report of high strangeness, he would scratch his chin—beardless until the fall of 1953—and say this might bear looking into. We would outline the information we wanted to have, and we would pass that on to Blue Book. But it hardly ever followed up for us. If we really wanted some information, we would have to go out and try to get it ourselves.

Hynek was paid to investigate only reports allocated to him by Blue Book. That meant that if we heard of a case in some other way—if someone called the observatory, say, or there was a newspaper story—we could not count it as an official case, and any expenses incurred by Hynek or me were not reimbursable. Many times we asked people to send a report in to Wright-Patterson so that a case we were already working on (privately) and had spent money investigating could become "official." Sometimes it worked; sometimes it didn't.

Hynek went to Wright-Patterson two or three times a month, and about once a month I went along. The Blue Book facility—building 263, not Hangar 18—consisted of three cramped, crummy little offices. The paint was peeling, and the file cabinets were warped. There were a United States map with pins stuck in it, a sergeant gofer, a gum-cracking, beehive-haired secretary (a civilian), and a dried-out coffee pot on the window sill. This was before computers, of course, so the cases were filed chronologically. If you knew the date, fine. If you knew only the location, try the card index, and lotsa luck. No wonder I never saw Capt. Ed Ruppelt, the Blue Book head, smile. (I remember him as a by-the-book sober-sides. I don't recall a human side of him, even when we were having an informal lunch. But I seem to remember intense blue-gray eyes.)

In the early days of my association with Hynek, my title was research assistant, OSU department of physics and astronomy. I worked a few hours a day, spending about half my time on UFO matters and the rest as teaching assistant for Hynek's undergraduate astronomy course and general Girl Friday for OSU's McMillin Observatory. (I was also carrying 15 hours in my second-to-last undergrad quarter.) As the year progressed I graduated, my Secret clearance came through, I worked full time, and my UFO work increased proportionately.

The 1954 flap was underway, and one day I asked Hynek how it was that OSU was willing to keep me on as research assistant when most of my work was for ATIC.

"You're not working for ATIC," Hynek said. "You're working for a contractor."

I had no idea what he meant. "A contractor," he repeated. "A contractor who doesn't want to be known. But don't worry about it. I've already told you too much."

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ACTION

PARAPHRASE NOT REQUIRED. SEE CRYPTO-CENTER
BEFORE DECLASSIFYING

ATIC

J. Atia

3. Atia
4.C. files

AIR 008
RR JEDWP JEDEN 222
DE JEPHQ 179C
R 202210Z
FM HQ USAF WASHDC
TO JEDWP/CGAMC WRIGHT PATTERSON AFB OHIO
INFO JEDEN/CGADC ENT AFB COLO
/C O N F I D E N T I A L / FROM AFOIN 54365 CGAMC PASS TO CG ATIC
ACTION ON MESSAGE QUOTED BELOW FROM HQ ADC ENT AFB COLO IS TRANSFERRED
TO ATIC CMA THE ORGANIZATION HAVING PRIMARY RESPONSIBILITY FOR UFO
PROGRAM. NO ADDITIONAL INFO AVAILABLE THIS HQ. MESSAGE READS
CMA NUMBER COC 86 DTG 20053Z. OUR AP RADIO NEWS SERVICE MSG
AP 182 5TH 15 MIN SUMMARY CMA TENTH ITEM CMA SLUGGED /DISC/
STATES THAT LUMINOUS OBJECTS TRAVELING AT SPEEDS FASTER THAN SOUND
HAVE BEEN OBSERVED AND TRACKED ON RADAR WITHIN PAST FEW DAYS IN
PORK CHOP AND OLD BALDY HILLS AREA WESTERN KOREAN FRONT.
/5TH 15 MIN SUMMARY SIGNED BY 1028 PES 19/. IN VIEW OF RADAR
SIGHTING OF POSSIBLY SIMILAR SUPERSONIC OBJECTS LAKE SUPERIOR
AREA 20/0135 TO 20/0200Z APR FURTHER INFO OR EVALUATION OF THIS
AP REPORT IS REQUESTED
20/2314Z APR JEPHQ

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But I did worry about it. My paychecks said Ohio State University. The phrase "laundered money" was not in common usage in those days.

I stewed over this for a few days—not more than a week or two—and then the courier came with the weekly reports. Same man, same car—a Chevy that bilious shade of GI green. For some reason I walked him back out to his car, and did an incredible double-take as he drove away. It wasn't a government car. It was his own car, with Ohio plates. This man's initials were V.E., and the car license plate was VE-29. What a stroke of luck: a spook with vanity plates!

Furthermore, he was from Columbus. The local Chevy dealer's name was on the license-plate holder.

Within five minutes I had raced over to the main OSU library, pulled down the Columbus city directory, and found the man's name and his place of employment: Battelle. Confronting Hynek with my intelligence coup resulted in a few days of negotiations with Stork followed by an increased work load.

I went on a number of field trips for Henry, and the security situation was almost invariably deplorable.

Hynek arranged for me to visit astronomer Clyde Tombaugh at White Sands Proving Ground, New Mexico, during a trip I had previously planned for winter break

1952. (This was a private trip; I paid for it myself.) Tombaugh, who in 1930 discovered the planet Pluto, had himself experienced an extraordinary UFO sighting in 1949. A large, transparent fuselage with lighted windows had sailed across his view as he enjoyed the evening in his backyard.

I arrived at White Sands after a cold and miserable pre-dawn bus ride from El Paso, and Tombaugh sent someone out to the gate to escort me to his office. We walked through hangars and offices and laboratories. "Oooh, what's *that*?" I asked. There were rockets and fancy instruments and equipment lying all over the place. "That's the new Nike," my escort said, "and that one over there's the Honest John." I was carrying no documents to identify myself as affiliated with ATIC. No one asked what kind of clearance I had. And at that time, December 1952, I had none.

The fifth horseman

Hynek also arranged for me to meet with Lincoln LaPaz, the eminent meteoriticist at the University of New Mexico. LaPaz had been consulted by the Air Force during the spate of green-fireball sightings over the Southwest. It was common knowledge that he was

~~SECRET~~ *g* RESTRICTED

C O P Y

10 Mar 53 *g*

FM CO 49TH FTR INTCP SQ DOW AFB BANGOR MAINE

TO JEPHQ/HQ USAF WASH 25 DC

INFO JEDWP/AIR TECH INT CENTER WRIGHT PATTERSON AFB OHIO

/R E S T R I C T E D/ FLYOBRPT / ATTN DIRECTOR OF INTELLIGENCE,
USAF. ATTN ATIAA-2C, AIR TECH INTELLIGENCE CENTER

INTEL 3-35. Unidentified object sighted at 0202Z, 8 March, 1953
near Kent Hill, Maine. It was described as a big red ball of fire
going west-north-west and was observed for about 12 minutes until
it disappeared beyond the horizon. A similar object was observed
at 0400Z, 1 Mar, 1953. High speed, no maneuvers, no exhaust. It
was a visual observation from the ground with no electronic equip-
ment used. The observer, Mr. Van Ethen, Physics Department, Kents
Hill Academy, was located at 70 degrees west and 44 degrees 24 minutes north.
He estimated that the object was 40 to 60 miles away and low in the sky.
The object was observed by three faculty members and ten students of the
academy. The weather was cold and clear with no wind. No physical
evidence available, no interception action taken and no known air
traffic in the area.

09/2200Z MAR JEPDW *Mar 8, 1953*
Maine
g

SECURITY INFORMATION

RESTRICTED

RESTRICTED

BREAKDOWN OF THE 1148 FLYOBRPTS
RECEIVED FROM ATIC
15 Jan - 15 Jul

VENUS J	[REDACTED]	18
VENUS P	[REDACTED]	11
FIREBALLS J	[REDACTED]	10
FIREBALLS P	[REDACTED]	6
BALLOONS J	[REDACTED]	6
BALLOONS P	[REDACTED]	12
MIRAGES	[REDACTED]	1
INSUF DATA	[REDACTED]	16
BIRDS	[REDACTED]	2
REFLECTIONS	[REDACTED]	4
OTHER ASTRO.	[REDACTED]	12
METEOROLOG.	[REDACTED]	2
RADAR ANOM.	[REDACTED]	2
UNKNOWN*	[REDACTED]	33
HOAX	[REDACTED]	1
UNCONVEN A/C	[REDACTED]	2

*. Follow up requested

J Justified by data

P Probable

interested in UFOs. (LaPaz is mentioned prominently in Ruppelt's *The Report on Unidentified Flying Objects* [1956].)

I found LaPaz in his office at the university. I remember the formality of the room, he behind a large wooden desk, I in a straight chair at right angles. In contrast to the easy-going Tombaugh (and his family, who treated me to a Mexican lunch), LaPaz was a formidable presence, and I felt a bit uncomfortable. We discussed UFOs in general terms. He chose his words carefully, suggesting that the U.S. government knew *plenty* about UFOs. I brought him up to date on Hynek's work and the general skepticism that I felt pervaded Hynek's philosophy (and mine, too).

LaPaz listened to what must have been my naive jabberings. Then he pinned me with a solemn stare. "UFOs are the Fifth Horseman of the Apocalypse," he said, and I was soon dismissed.

Pestilence, War, Famine, Death, and . . . ? As the years have passed, LaPaz's chilling pronouncement has caused me growing concern. His name is not listed on the controversial MJ-12 document. But if such a group, or its equivalent, existed, he would have been a logical candidate for membership.

Back in Ohio the summer of 1953 produced a changing of the guard. For a few months Ruppelt was away, and Lt. Bob Olsson was in charge of Blue Book. At some time in that interval Hynek was going out of town, and he told me to expect a visit from some people from Wright-Patterson. Olsson (whom I already knew) came in, with the sergeant gofer and another man, probably also a lieutenant, to whom I was not even introduced.

It was a hot, stuffy day sans air conditioning. The soldiers took me into Hynek's inner office at the observatory, and the lieutenant arranged the chairs: a straight chair in the center of the room—for me—and three other chairs at 10, two, and six o'clock positions. The anonymous lieutenant and Olsson faced me, and the sergeant sat out of my vision with a clip board and pencil.

They asked me how things were going with the project. What was Hynek's attitude? What was my attitude? How did I like the work? What did I think of this case or that? My utter disingenuousness carried me through this ordeal. In my naivete I was probably even flattered to be the object of so much attention. In retrospect the third man reminds me of that nutty CIA man in the *M.A.S.H.* television series—the ludicrous paranoid who was forever finding devious plots in the most innocent situation.

I liked Bob Olsson. He often included his own evaluations and a friendly note on the reports sent to us, and I felt he was genuinely interested and conscientious in his work. Perhaps that's why he lasted only a few months at Blue Book.

By mid-1956 Hynek had moved to Harvard for his work on the International Geophysical Year, and I had moved to the main Battelle campus (about a mile from

OSU) where my work for Stork also involved the IGY. The subject of UFOs was never mentioned.

Blue Book and beyond

Though I was officially removed from Blue Book business, Hynek and I continued to communicate regularly about UFO matters.

At midnight on March 26, 1966, my husband got me out of a shower for a call from Hillsdale, Michigan. It was Hynek, pleading with me not to get upset when I saw the morning papers. The Air Force had backed him into a corner. *Say something*, he was told. So he had said something. He had said that swamp gas was a possibility as a natural explanation for some lights over a marshy area, and the press jumped on it. The swamp-gas incident distressed him terribly because in effect the Air Force had forced him to compromise his scientific integrity.

Blue Book folded the end of 1969 following the publication of the Condon Report. Within a few months of the *start* of the Colorado project, Hynek had told me he knew it had been decided that the findings would be negative. For years he had understood that he was being kept out of the inner circle, that even with his high security clearances it was judged that he had no need to know what was really going on. He knew he had been used. He seemed actually relieved, then, when his Blue Book work was over. Now he was free to pursue UFO research from a purely scientific viewpoint without the restrictions imposed by his government contract.

But was Hynek's government UFO work *really* over?

In October 1973 he called me to pick him up at Wright-Patterson and bring him to Columbus. It was the height of the Yom Kippur war, and Wright-Patterson was on highest security status because supplies for Israel were being flown from there. I took a wrong turn near the Air Force museum entrance and wound up driving out onto the perimeter of the field. I drove half a mile out on a taxi strip before I could turn around. No challenge. No one came after me.

I finally got reoriented and drove up to where I was supposed to pick up Hynek. It was a small one-storey building, and Hynek was standing in the doorway as I drove up. Another man appeared from the building. He was in dress uniform and may have been a major. I got out of the car, and Hynek made it a point to introduce me. Of course Hynek was always polite, but he easily could have just gotten into the car with no introductions. It seemed to me that the introduction was a purposeful act which I assumed had something to do with the fact that I was a UFO associate.

On our way to Columbus I asked Hynek in general terms what was going on. He would not tell me anything about what he was doing at Wright-Patterson. In face of his reluctance to explain, I felt I could not pursue the subject. But he was agitated on that trip and seemed

continued on page 23

UFO activities in the Soviet Union

by Richard F. Haines

■ ■ Richard F. Haines, Ph.D., an aviation psychologist and contributing editor to *IUR*, is author, most recently, of *Advanced Aerial Devices Reported During the Korean War* (1990).

I had the opportunity to meet a number of Soviet scientists both in Moscow and in Novosibirsk in the middle of February of this year and discuss a variety of topics as well as carry out a detailed interview and hypnosis session. This report summarizes these experiences.

On February 18 in Moscow I met Dr. Vladimir Rubtsov of the Kharkov Engineering and Pedagogical Institute, Kharkov. (I first met him on November 12, 1988, in Brussels at the First International UFO Congress of Brussels. He is the author, with A. D. Ursul, of *Problems of Extraterrestrial Civilizations: Philosophical and Methodological Aspects* [1987].) He had arranged for me to meet with the "Expert Group on Anomalous Phenomena" of the Soviet Academy of Sciences that afternoon to discuss current UFO events in America and the Soviet Union. I first met Dr. Yulii Platov, Institute of Terrestrial Magnetism, Ionosphere and Radio Wave Propagation prior to arriving at the ultramodern Academy of Sciences Building south of the city center.

Present at this meeting were Drs. Alexander A. Panov, Geophysics Institute, Commission on Ecological Problems—Devices Department; Valery Miliaev, Vice Director of the General Physics Institute and Director of the Tarusa GPI Branch; V. Feschin, Scientific-Technical Institute; V. Sokolov, Center of Program Research; G. Kulikova, IZMIRAN; V. Klepikov, IZMIRAN; Sergey Chernouss, Head of Laboratory, Polar Geophysical Institute; and Rubtsov. The head of this group, Dr. V. V. Migulin, corresponding member of the Academy of Sciences of the U.S.S.R., could not be present.

I had the privilege of reviewing my ongoing pilot-sighting research with special emphasis on the electromagnetic effects and statistical findings as well as various photographic cases in which I had been involved. This was followed by my 35mm-slide presentation on photographic and CE2 evidence which elicited a great deal of discussion. It was obvious that they were unaware of this evidence but that it seemed to correspond in large degree

with data they had collected.

There has been a great deal of UFO activity in the Soviet Union over the past years. Some of these events have been documented by Dr. Felix Zigel in his series of six volumes of typed reports. I was most fortunate to obtain a bound set of these from Dr. Serge Bozich, applied mathematician. They are three volumes *Nablydeneya NLO B CCCP (Observations of UFOs in the U.S.S.R.)*, 1968, 1975, 1978; *Fenomen NLO B 1978 Gody (UFO Phenomena in 1978)*, 1979; *Posadke NLO B CCCP U Drygeck Stranax (UFO Landings in the U.S.S.R. and Other Nations)*, 1979; and *Petrozavodskoye Devo—20 Centyabrya 1977 Goda (Petrozavodsk Events of September 20, 1977)*, 1980.

Other more recent sightings are being documented in a new publication, *Anomaleya (Anomalies)*, edited by Serge F. Bulantsev. (Bulantsev took part in the nationally televised show *UFO Cover-up? . . . Live* broadcast from Washington, D.C., in October 1988.) Issue 1 was released in Moscow in January 1991 and consisted of 32 pages with clearly typeset text. This issue contained brief descriptions and discussions of sightings on November 22, 1989; August 3, 1990, at 2345 hours local time in Kirov Region; August 3, 1990, in Tversk Region; August 18 and 19, 1990, in Uzbekistan; July 31, 1989, at 2103 hours local time in Kazakhstan; July 26, 1990; June 22, 1990, at night in Kazakhstan and four black-and-white photos (February 1990 of lens flare; March 21, 1990, from the Ukraine; February 3, 1985, from Yalta; and October 15, 1968, from the Kolskii Peninsula).

Another new publication is a newspaper entitled *NLO Ekspress (UFO Express)*. The first issue was published in Novosibirsk in January 1991 and consisted of 24 pages.

An interesting article published in the March 31, 1990, issue of *Vechernyaya Moskva (Moscow Evening News)*. Page 4, titled "Metamorfozi" (Metamorphosis), reviews a sighting of February 23-24, 1990, in Odessa. Sixteen separate phases of appearance were described in drawings and in text. I collected newspaper clippings for more than a dozen other sightings.

A visit to Novosibirsk

I spent a week in Novosibirsk lecturing at the state university, the Electrotechnical Institute, and elsewhere. During this time I met these ufologists: Evgenii V.

Vorozhtsov, Institute of Theoretical and Applied Mechanics of the U.S.S.R. Siberian Division (Academy of Sciences); Eugen E. Vityaev, Institute of Mathematics; and B. Yu. Scobelev, Institute of Theoretical and Applied Mechanics. They have developed an interesting computer algorithm which performs detailed extraction of most of the available information in each UFO report. Forty different features of the sighting are coded within a series of phases; each phase consists of a given flight dynamic.

There is a small but serious UFO study group in Novosibirsk consisting of about 20 persons, 10 of whom play a central and ongoing role. They formed their group in 1978 as a result of receiving so many letters from persons who had seen strange aerial phenomena. Almost none of the university scientists wanted to study these reports, so a small specialist group formed (initially) to carry out correspondence with eyewitnesses and other investigators. Drs. Zigel, Kuzofkin, Proetski, Migulin, and others visited Novosibirsk over the years. I spoke with Drs. Svegenii Zhibizov, Victor Zhuravliev, and Aleksii Dmitriev of the state university. Each of these individuals was deeply involved in field research in the region.

Dr. Dmitriev told me about one of his own sightings. It took place at night in 1976 during a field expedition on geomagnetic characteristics of the earth. Another member in his party took six consecutive photographs of the chevron-shaped lighted object. Though the photographer said he centered the light in the camera's view finder, after development the object's image was found to be displaced laterally about 30 degrees' arc for no apparent reason. Others using two additional cameras also obtained photographic images of the object. They noted fluctuations in the local magnetic field when the object was hovering nearby, and no such variations were noted at another sensor site 140 kilometers away. The variations lasted 14 minutes, and the light was seen by nine witnesses. This case was never written up.

I also met a jet-pilot instructor, Vladimir Kuzmin, who has flown for 13 years and who has had several unusual sightings. He flew to Novosibirsk from Chelabinsk to tell me his stories. One of these events took place on December 24 or 25, 1989, while he was flying alone in an L-29 (a two-seat jet trainer) about 48 kilometers south of the center of Chelabinsk. While flying at an altitude of 8000 meters making various aerobatic maneuvers, he noticed a yellow-white cigar-shaped object to the north of him an estimated distance of from 18 to 25 kilometers. He estimated it to be at an altitude of 7500 meters. It subtended an angle of about five degrees' arc and always remained horizontal and stationary. After he performed a vertical loop where he could once again look in its direction, it had disappeared from view.

Our careful event reconstruction established that he looked at it for a total of about four minutes. Sometime after he landed, he noticed that his exposed facial region was covered with a thick crust which was sensitive

though not painful to the touch. It was similar to a skin scald and was red. It gradually subsided and was gone after 10 or 12 days. No nausea, dizziness, or other physiological effects were noted after the sighting. He did not report the incident to authorities. (It should be noted that his airplane had a plexiglass canopy which blocks a large percentage of ultraviolet radiation. UV wavelengths are those that are known to cause sunburn. Either the UFO emitted very high levels of UV radiation, or the skin crust that formed was due to an entirely different physiological response mechanism. It probably wasn't microwave radiation because there was no permanent tissue damage or pain experienced.)

Somewhat later Kuzmin admitted that he had also seen a strange silent light in the night sky while camping out with several friends. The event took place in the autumn of 1979 near the town of Octoberskaya. All he could recall was watching a dark aerial body (with several dim lights across its equator) move smoothly toward them just above the tree tops. It emitted an intense, strangely shaped cone of white light which shone down. The circle of light was brighter than daylight (white or light yellow) and estimated to be about 100 meters away from them. Its diameter was two to three acres in size. All of the witnesses were paralyzed but could move their heads and eyes. The object and its beam stopped for a moment and then continued on out of sight.

When I heard that there might be a temporal discontinuity in his experience, I felt that it might be worthwhile to use time-regression hypnosis to explore his unconscious recall of this event. While I began the trance induction in Russian, I had to transfer the detailed instructions to a native, who spoke on my behalf in a controlled and measured tone of voice. I—we—succeeded in achieving a deep trance relatively quickly in Kuzmin, and a great deal of valuable additional information was obtained via the translator. My prehypnotic induction instructions emphasized listening only to the translator's voice and not to mine. I will report the details of this case elsewhere.

In summary, I learned that much the same UFO activities are taking place in these two parts of the Soviet Union as they are in America. I found that there are relatively more highly trained physical scientists studying unidentified aerial phenomena in the Soviet Union and also that their peers often deride them for their efforts. They fund their efforts out of pocket as we do and have few places in which to publish their work. We in the West should share our data with our Soviet colleagues whenever possible. ■

Debunking, Soviet style

by Paul Stonehill

■ ■ Paul Stonehill, a Soviet emigre who lives in Los Angeles, publishes articles on UFOs and related matters in Russian-language periodicals.

In *How 20th Century Myths Are Born*, published as a mass-market paperback by Lenizdat in 1988, two Soviet scientists, A. M. Kondratov, philologist, and K. K. Shilik, of the Leningrad division of the Institute of Archaeology of the Academy of Sciences, employ rigid Marxist-Leninism in an effort to debunk belief in UFOs, ancient astronauts, and the Bermuda Triangle. We are told that a Soviet Marxist professor reviewed and approved the manuscript, as did a bureaucrat from the Ministry of Culture. These dubious credentials notwithstanding, the book is not entirely worthless and in fact contains some interesting material.

As have professional debunkers in the West where their own fellow citizens are concerned, Kondratov and Shilik express alarm about the growing interest of the Soviet public in the "new mythology." For that they blame Western bourgeois society's influences. They heap scorn on those Soviet scientists and writers who take seriously ufology's extraterrestrial hypothesis as well as those who seek bold answers for what we in Russia call "riddles of antiquity."

They lash out at Alexander Kasantsev, an ardent supporter of the ancient-ET visitation idea (but not a flaming liberal dissident either). The ancient-ET visitation "myth" is called here "paleocontact." For the past quarter-century Kasantsev has been the principal defender of the paleocontact hypothesis. He writes science-fiction novels and stories, gets them published in the most popular magazines, lectures on radio and television, and introduces authors who present their ideas about ETs and alien traces. Another target is M. M. Agrest, a Soviet physicist who in 1960 speculated that ETs visited the earth thousands of years ago. The Soviet public learned of his ideas that year when an interview with him was published in the *Literaturnaya Gazeta* and later in his article "The Cosmonauts of Antiquity" which appeared in a popular digest, *Na Sushe y na More (On Land and in the Sea)*.

Curiously, the authors do not mention Gorbovsky's writings. Gorbovsky was one of the first Soviet authors to discuss riddles of antiquity. I first encountered his work

in 1971 when I was vacationing with my family in a small village on the shore of the Black Sea. That summer I participated in an archaeological dig at an ancient Greek polis on the Berezen (or the Lt. Shmidt Island, depending on one's respect for Soviet history and adherence to Ukrainian nationalism) and read an article (savagely abridged, I learned later) by Gorbovsky. Published in the magazine *Mir Priklyucheniye (World of Adventures)*, it dealt with ancient myths and legends as possible evidence that our planet once entertained space visitors. That article changed my life, and I began gathering my own evidence through research and reading.

Some years ago I was able to obtain Gorbovsky's book, the 1971 edition, from whence the article was taken. A tiny and precious monograph, I cherish it, as much as I cherish the *Earth Chronicles* books by Z. Sitchin. My hope is that the two writers, one Russian, the other American, will meet some day and that their books will become available in both languages. I understand that Gorbovsky has recently published a book, written with Yulian Semyonov (a talented espionage novelist who has ties, it is said, to the KGB and who, to his discredit, has also churned out propaganda novels) on the subject of the world's dark secrets.

Having dispatched Agrest, Kondratov and Shilik set their sights on I. S. Shklovsky, a supporter of Agrest and a Soviet astrophysicist. Shklovsky, an associate member of the Academy of Sciences, wrote a book, *Universe, Life, and Mind* (1962), and in it credited Agrest with providing a scientific basis by which to judge the issue of ancient ET visitation. Another object of the debunkers' fury is Leningrad University philologist V. K. Zaitsev, who in the early 1960s lectured and wrote on "cosmic reminiscences"—in other words, possible ET references in myths and legends.

Kondratov and Shilik ridicule Erich von Daniken, always an easy target. A Western film based on von Daniken's books was popular in the Soviet Union, I am told; by the time of its appearance, I had left the country.

To my surprise the authors have nothing to say about Sitchin and his books. They do attack well-known Western ufologists and paleocontact proponents. Often they cite Western debunkers (especially Donald H. Menzel). They resent the Soviet public's growing fascination with ET speculations, deeming it a "thirst for a miracle."

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Harvesting useful data from crop circles

by Chris Rutkowski

■ ■ Chris Rutkowski, an *IUR* contributing editor, is a graduate student at the University of Manitoba. He edits *Swamp Gas Journal*. He is associated with the Winnipeg-based North American Institute for Crop Circle Research.

As most people are aware, 1990 saw a huge increase in the number of crop circles discovered in England and around the world. Starting with a mere trickle at the beginning of the 1980s and then culminating in many hundreds by the end of the decade, world attention has been focused upon Britain as several different factions approach the mystery from their own directions, with correspondingly frantic rhetoric.

The circles themselves have been evolving with time, or so it seems. Originally fairly dull, round markings, they have progressed to multiple rings, "corridors" leading to satellite circles, and finally complex structures involving key shapes, hieroglyphics, and even triangles. The change in the appearance of the circles has caused circle researchers continually to refine and modify their theories on circle creation. If the issue is ever resolved, at least some theorists will have a steady diet of crow on which to dine in the near future.

What some researchers seem to have forgotten is that the phenomenon is not new. Flattened circles and rings have been found in fields for many decades, and it has even been noted that medieval woodcuts may show crop circles as well. While the British circles are said to have begun around 1980, Canadian ufologists are familiar with the Langenburg and Rossburn trace cases of the 1970s, and New Zealand researchers examined a similar bunch of circles at about the same time. We ought also to recall the "saucer nests" in Australia and Canada in the 1960s. Ted Phillips is said to have over 4000 trace cases on file by now, and a significant number of these are "crop circles" going back many years.

The theories

Though crop circles are not new historically, their sheer numbers in recent years have drawn much attention, especially on the plains of England. In fact, the large numbers tend to preclude or at least wreak havoc with some theories about their creation. There are four basic

kinds of theories: meteorological; hoax; UFO; and other.

Proponents of the meteorological explanation include Terence Meaden and Jenny Randles. Meaden's numerous articles on vortex-caused crop circles date back to the early 1980s, mostly published in the journal he edits. Meteorologists appear to be polarized in their support for the theory. While many publicly agree that the circles are likely of meteorological origin, just as many point out that there is no consistent mechanism which would physically explain all the observed effects. The idea that winds blowing over small hills form eddies which eventually propagate into strong vortices sounds good in theory but fails to account for the circles appearing on the flat Canadian prairies, nor does it answer the question of why so many have appeared in 1990. Randles has noted a few dozen eyewitness accounts of wind vortices creating crop circles, and these do lend support to the theory, but what about dozens of eyewitness accounts of UFOs creating "saucer nests"? Does either of these sets of observation necessarily prove the theories?

Recently, on a Cleveland radio talk show, Don Berliner, Grant Cameron, and I discussed crop circles and dealt with one caller who insisted that Occam's razor demands that we conclude crop circles are simply hoaxes. The caller failed to understand that the hoax explanation has not been dismissed out of hand. In fact, some circles have been conclusively proven to be hoaxes. The problem is that no one explanation is without problems.

A poststructural study of crop circles recognizes the weaknesses of each theory and tries to resolve the issues from a more objective standpoint. This is easy in principle but difficult in the face of the passions inherent in ufology and anomalistics. Perhaps the best way to phrase it is this: no theory is correct, but no one theory is incorrect either. Hence, the UFO theory can explain some of the effects but falls short of describing exactly how the circles are created, why aliens would want to make them in the first place, and how they would fit into the ufological scheme of things.

Proponents of UFO-generated crop circles include Colin Andrews and Pat Delgado in Britain, Michael Chorost in the United States, and Grant Cameron in Canada. UFO files are brimming with physical-trace cases, and many involved flattened grass or other vegetation. What are we to do with the Tully saucer nests or the Langenburg swirls in rapeseed? Must we discount close-

This is an independent survey designed to obtain information and opinions about a specific topic from a variety of people working in the broad subject area of Agriculture. Your response to this survey is important in determining an approach to research in several fields of study.

This is a non-invasive study. Please do not include your name if you do not wish to do so.

PLEASE ANSWER THE FOLLOWING QUESTIONS BY MAKING A MARK IN THE SPACE(S) PROVIDED

1. What is your area of expertise, or your background?
a) agricultural economics ____ b) agricultural engineering ____ c) animal science ____
d) entomology ____ e) food science ____ f) plant science ____ g) soil science ____
h) soil survey ____ i) toxicology ____ j) other (please specify) _____
2. Have you heard or read anything about "mystery crop circles"? Y ____ N ____
If YES, continue with this survey. If NO, do not proceed with this survey.
3. What do you believe is the cause of "mystery crop circles"?
a) wind effects ____ b) hoaxes ____ c) animals ____ d) insects ____ e) crop diseases ____
f) UFOs ____ g) religious cults ____ h) other (please specify) _____
4. Have you, yourself, ever personally examined a "mystery crop circle"? Y ____ N ____
5. Have you, yourself, ever personally examined any of the following:
a) tornado track ____ b) dust devil or whirlwind marks ____ c) fertilizer burn ____
d) fairy ring ____ e) lightning ground strike ____ f) ungulate resting area ____
g) animal diggings ____ h) farm equipment field storage marks ____
6. Do you personally know anyone who had found a "crop circle" in a field? Y ____ N ____
If YES, in what general area? (i.e. Brunkhild, Lockport, etc.) _____
7. Do you believe you could (if desired) fabricate or otherwise create a "crop circle"?
Y ____ N ____ If YES, by what method? (briefly) _____
8. What area of expertise do you think should be concerned with "mystery crop circles"?
a) agriculture ____ b) psychology ____ c) sociology ____ d) anthropology ____
e) history ____ f) philosophy ____ g) religion ____ h) education ____
i) engineering ____ j) microbiology ____ k) biology ____ l) law/law enforcement ____
m) psychiatry ____ n) astronomy ____ o) botany ____ p) chemistry ____
q) geology ____ r) physics ____ s) zoology ____ t) other: _____
9. Do you think there should be a formal investigation of "mystery crop circles"? Y ____ N ____
Why or Why Not? _____
If your answer was YES, by Which organization or group? _____
10. Would you, personally, like to be involved in such an investigation? Y ____ N ____
If NO, why? a) out of my subject area ____ b) no value towards own research ____
c) no time ____ d) too busy ____ e) not interested ____ f) other: _____

Your Further Comments:

range testimony in favor of a meteorological explanation?

Finally, the fourth category, "other," includes everything from the infamous "mating hedgehogs" to satanist cults to invisible giant grasshoppers (really!). It should be obvious that these various theories have limited support and appeal; yet they do explain, at least ostensibly, certain characteristics of the circle phenomenon. The evidence for each is not overwhelming, and the fact that they have been proposed at all indicates the absence of any consensus among researchers.

The circles' diversity presents a serious challenge to would-be explainers. How, to start with, does one define a crop circle? Do we include burned patches in soybean fields, concentric circles of enhanced growth in grass and swirled triangles in grain? And what about the British case in which the words "WE ARE NOT ALONE" were found carved into a field? A systematic approach to the analyses of crop circles is desperately needed, and it is hoped that computer databases of crop circles and physical traces being produced by the North American Institute for Crop Circles, UFO Research Manitoba, the Fund for UFO Research, and others in England will clear up some of this confusion.

When media do stories about crop circles, they often seek "experts." Besides the main proponents of various theories, reporters may interview meteorologists, astronomers, and agriculturists in search of an authoritative opinion. But do these specialists really know anything more than the average crop-circle researcher? Some surveys of meteorologists and agriculturists have been done, and the results have not yet been widely distributed. Generally, however, the surveys have shown that so-called experts are poorly informed; typically they express opinions without having any experience with the subject or knowledge about it.

The survey

A preliminary survey was conducted on the campus of the University of Manitoba in 1990. This pilot project was designed to determine whether or not the information obtained from such a survey would produce useful results if carried elsewhere. Nine crop circles were discovered within a 50-mile radius of the university in 1990, and some of these received a considerable amount of publicity. One circle was even found on a farm owned by a college lecturer.

A total of 155 nonintrusive surveys were placed in campus mailboxes of academic and support staff in the Faculty of Agriculture. Thirty-seven surveys were returned, and these were used in the analyses of the results. This represented an over 20-percent response, considered a good return for independent surveys.

I anticipated that respondents would propose explanations without investigation and that they would have limited experience with field markings of any kind. In both instances I was proven right.

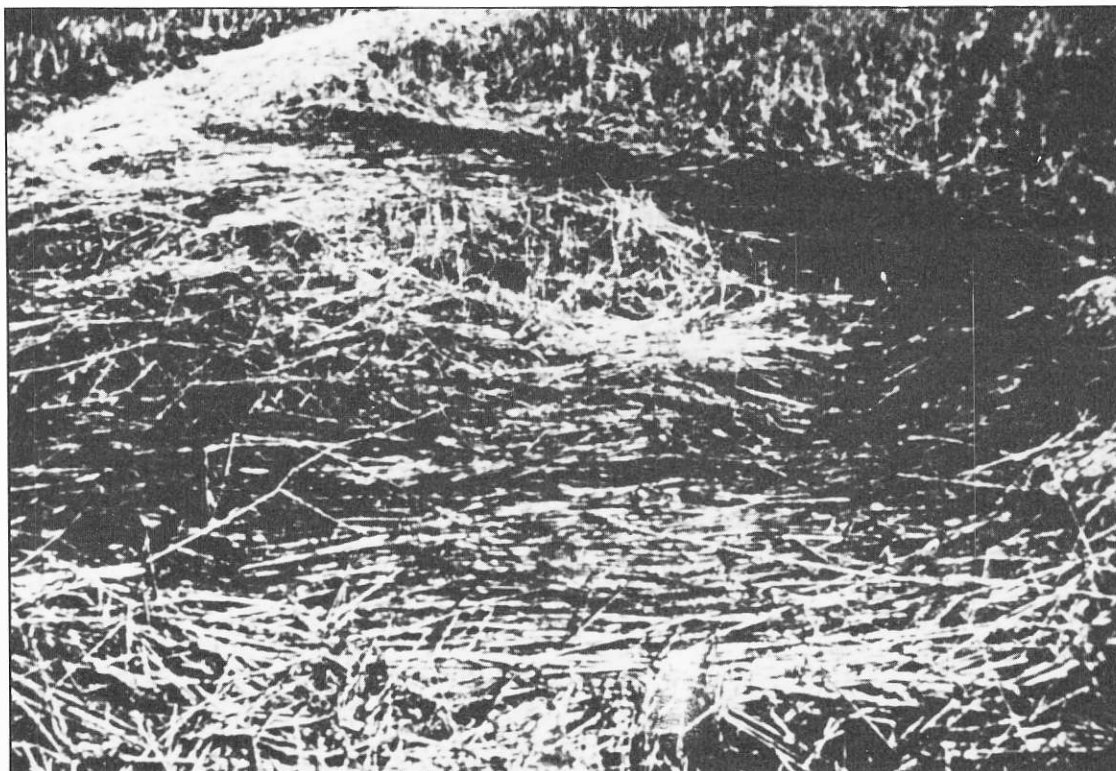
Of those respondents listing an area of expertise, the majority were in plant science, agricultural engineering, and animal science. When asked for their opinions on the cause of crop circles, most suggested hoaxes and wind effects. Perhaps surprisingly, three suggested UFOs were the cause of the markings; possibly they may not have meant "aliens" but merely some unknown aerial phenomenon. Two respondents suggested crop-lodging as the cause. This phenomenon occurs when a crop grows abnormally fast under extreme conditions, and it mats together in a spaghetti-like fashion. In other words, the crop *naturally* forms in the tangled manner, and the circular effect is a product of this growth. Unfortunately, as anyone who has examined a crop circle will testify, the grain or crop is physically bent over, and this differs from lodging in other ways as well. The opinions of agricultural "experts" about crop circles begin to look suspect at this point, and the situation does not improve as we go further.

Only one respondent had personally examined a crop circle; yet most others felt they had enough information to express an opinion. One respondent noted that he could not offer an opinion because he had not done any original research. This is the true reflection of scientific objectivity, and we can note that bias is evident in agriculturists' views of crop circles, as it is in most other scientific data collection.

The number of surveyed agriculturists who had actually seen ground traces is encouraging. Over half had seen fertilizer burns, which do not resemble crop circles but could conceivably be used to explain some alleged UFO-landing traces. Significant numbers had seen fairy rings, marks left by equipment in fields, and those produced by animals. Few had seen tornado tracks or lightning strikes, but because of the rarity of these phenomena, this is not surprising.

Though "dust devil or whirlwind mark" was included and 10 respondents indicated they had seen one, this was a bit of a ruse. Dust devils do not leave any marks as such, but they will leave piles of debris when they dissipate. Several years ago I examined a large dust devil at close range. It was 25 feet in diameter and about 200 feet in height; fine structure of its interior microvortices could be seen, and the funnel persisted long enough for it to be entered (and exited!) briefly. No visible ground marks were left within the path of this fairly powerful example of the phenomenon.

Whirlwinds, on the other hand, can flatten or otherwise disturb standing crops, but most farmers will agree that the effects are temporary and often irregular in appearance. It is conceivable (and certainly possible, given the testimonies of eyewitnesses located by Randles) that strong whirlwinds would cause long-lasting damage. What would be ideal would be a comparative photographic presentation of these and other ground markings, for reference when investigating "real" crop circles. Several researchers are now assembling such a collection.



Question 6 brought responses from eight who knew of their colleague's discovery of a circle in his field. It is not very revealing. But the next question is more interesting. Respondents were about equal in their belief that they could envision a way to duplicate a crop circle. A few were ludicrous, for example those that mentioned helicopters or hovercraft. Most of those who felt they could create a circle held to the notion of trampling the crop by foot or with rollers; some realized the need for precision and suggested pegs or stakes in the center to ensure roundness. Of course most circles and rings are not totally round, as Cameron has noted. Still, this seems a logical way to create the effect.

One comment about the use of stilts needs to be addressed here. After a British tabloid published instructions on how to create the circles, some hoaxers tried the methods described. Following the discovery of circles in Canada, local media advertised the techniques. Investigators fashioned makeshift stilts and tried to enter a field, but the instability of the soil ensured that the stilts left significant marks in the ground, and it was felt that the method was inappropriate for the local situation. Nevertheless some kind of stilts could likely be used to make certain markings found at crop-circle sites. In other words, investigators should not discard the idea altogether.

As for the areas of expertise, physicists may be shocked to learn they have been nominated as the group most concerned with crop-circle research (perhaps atmospheric physics is what the respondents had in mind). Agriculturalists concede that they, too, should be involved, and it would have been surprising had they noted otherwise. Other fields of expertise suggested for crop-circle research ranged from history to geology (?),

and astronomers may be as embarrassed to be rated as high as botanists for their input into the matter. The most important piece of information obtained from this question is that crop circles seem to be an interdisciplinary phenomenon.

Should scientists study crop circles? Most respondents replied in the negative, and this, again, is unsurprising considering the ridicule curtain that exists in science with regard to anomalous phenomena. Crop-circle research probably would not look good on curriculum vitae, especially when one is applying for tenure. Nonetheless three respondents suggested they would like to be involved in investigations, and the previous question about formal investigations yielded some interesting results.

Those who thought there should be a formal investigation of crop circles seemed open-minded. Some wanted to know only how the hoaxers had created them. Others wanted to know more about the cause, natural or otherwise. Several indicated that scientific information would come out of an investigation. Of those who did not think a formal investigation was in order, many considered circle research a waste of time, but it seems this was likely due to a perception that the circles are all hoaxes. The need to catch circle hoax perpetrators seemed a low priority, and the possibility that the circles were anything out of the ordinary was not considered, even though respondents acknowledged they had never examined them personally. There was no consensus as to who should lead a formal investigation: police, "credible" university researchers, or ufologists.

The miscellaneous comments offered at the end of the survey form showed a wide range of opinion. One

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Airships: Part II

by Jerome Clark

■ ■ Jerome Clark is editor of *IUR* and vice president of CUFOs. His books include *UFOs in the 1980s* (1990) and (with J. Gordon Melton and Aidan A. Kelly) *New Age Almanac* (1990). The following article is adapted from his forthcoming *The Emergence of a Phenomenon* (Apogee Books), a study of the early years of the UFO controversy.

The airship identified

Let us now consider what we have:

We began with a comprehensive review of what at first appearance is a bizarre, wildly anomalous event in the early history of the UFO phenomenon: the 1896-97 American airship scare. As we have seen, this event has been a source of enormous confusion and controversy, giving encouragement to supernatural speculators (Keel, Vallee), to debunkers (Menzel), and to psychosocial hypothesizers (Arts, Bartholomew, Evans), all working from the premise that the airship affair “proves” that UFO manifestations reflect human cultural expectations and thus—depending on the theorizers’ bias—are paranormal shapeshifters (either “ultraterrestrials” or “materialized psychisms”) or, less grandly and more believably, hallucinations and misperceptions.

These sorts of hypotheses are fundamentally flawed. They mistakenly assume that the late-19th-Century press was relating more or less accurately what sincere people were reporting. Yet we know now that this was not the case, that the press played the affair for laughs and had not the slightest qualms about printing vast amounts of outrageous fiction about airships and their occupants. Even so, we need not abandon all hope; we have other airship reports from other sources and places. From them we get a much clearer idea of what people were actually reporting. We learn that cylindrical, *nonluminous* (an important point) metallic objects with lights on their sides, searchlights, and, on occasion, wings have been observed all through our century. Until the late 1910s or so, they were usually called “airships.” After the airship scares were forgotten and witnesses (before Arnold, anyway) had no context into which to place these weird sights, they were called nothing in particular except mysterious, though frequently witnesses first thought they

were observing a dirigible—until the object did something no dirigible could do.

In short, stripped of all the lies, practical jokes, and exaggerations, the 1896-97 affair turns out to be a conventional UFO wave in all particulars, including this one, implicitly known to UFO students but seldom mentioned: though many types of UFOs were seen, one type dominated the wave. In post-Arnold waves sighting concentrations have been defined variously by flame- or smoke-spewing cylinders (1946), daylight discs (1947), flying wings (1983), triangles (recently), or even CE3s (1973). Yet in all instances other sorts of UFOs, though largely overlooked in the attendant publicity, were also appearing.

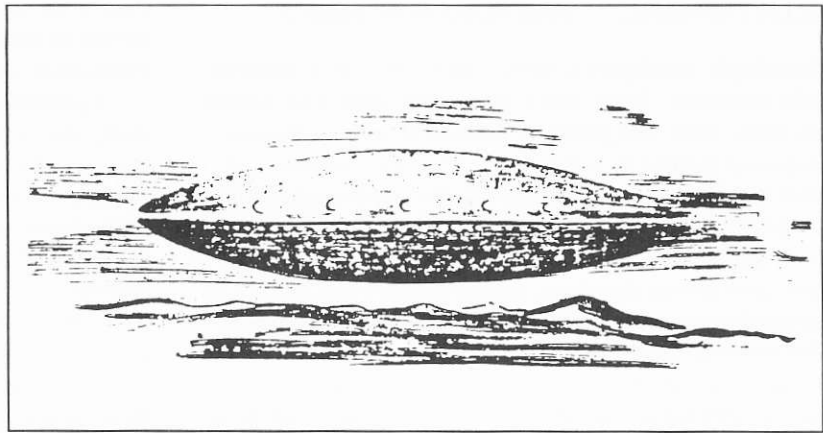
What gives the 1896-97 wave its particular interest—and explains at least some of the reason it has baffled ufologists for so long—is that the dominant UFO was of a type that, while widely reported over the last century, *has never been remarked on in the UFO literature*. Airship UFOs are not simply the classic cigar shapes, as chroniclers from Keyhole onward have depicted them. Certainly these objects are often characterized, accurately enough, as cigar-shaped (though as late as 1957, in—of all places—McMinnville, Oregon, a UFO was said to resemble an “airship” [*Flying Saucer Digest*, December 1958, p. 7]), but that is only the beginning of a proper classification, because several varieties of cylindrical UFOs from “ghost rockets” to “motherships” to “cloud cigars” have been voluminously chronicled, and airships are none of these. No one has noticed how often witnesses report structures that look generally like dirigibles, that carry bright searchlights, and that, unlike other UFOs observed in darkness, are not luminous. At the very least this puts the lie to the argument that witnesses’ perceptions are shaped wholly by popular conceptions of what UFOs are supposed to look like. In the absence of an airship-UFO model, it seems obvious that here the objects observed, not the witnesses’ preconceived notions, are driving the testimony.

The numerous post-Arnold sightings of airship UFOs will be the subject of a later article, in which a fuller delineation of the characteristics of this UFO type will be made. Before the present article ends, however, we will consider just one example, a case the U.S. Air Force investigated and pronounced unexplained in *Project Blue Book Special Report 14* (Maccabee, 1979).

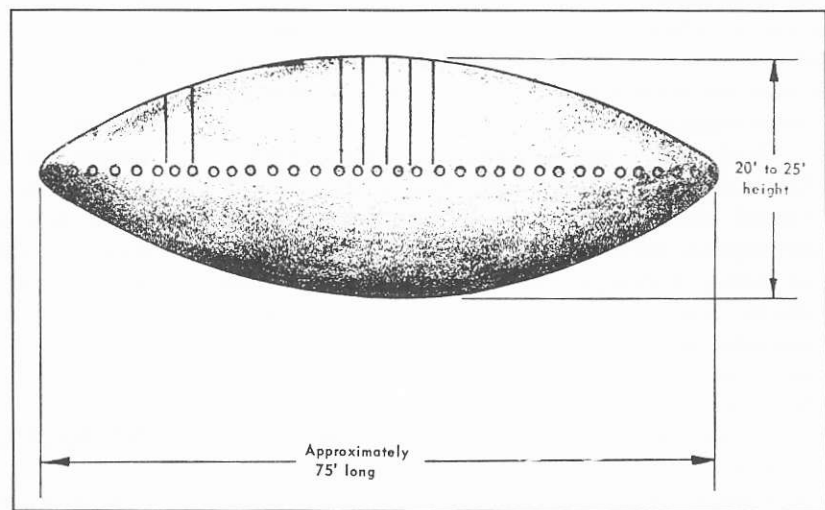
On August 25, 1952, around 6 a.m., a Pittsburg, Kansas, musician named William Squyres was driving to work at a local radio station when, according to the Air Force account, "he noted the unknown object off to the right side of the road at a horizontal angle of about 40 degrees and at a distance of about 250 yards. He immediately started slowing down his car and continued to view the object through the right side of [the] windshield. When he came to a point where [the] object was visible through the right door glass and about 90 degrees to [the] right of his vehicle, [he] opened the door and stepped out on the road. At all times, he attempted to keep [the] object in view.

"After he had stepped to [the] side of the road nearest the object, it began a rapid vertical ascent. Squyres estimated he viewed [the] object for about one-half minute. When [the] object reached a height 'about as high as an airplane flies' [the] object then increased acceleration at a tremendous rate and rapidly disappeared from view, straight up through broken clouds. Clouds did not obscure view of [the] disappearing object at any time.

"Squyres described the object as platter-shaped; by this he said it looked like two platters or bowls had been put together by reversing one platter and placing it over the first one. He estimated it was about 75 feet long and 40 feet wide and about 15 feet through the mid-section, measuring vertically in center of [the] object. [The] object was about 10 feet above the ground. Squyres then went on with a more detailed explanation of the object: It was of a dull aluminum color; smooth surface; one window in the front section, with head and shoulders visible of one man sitting motionless facing [the] forward edge of object, clear glass, light in forward section, medium blue continuous light. In the midsection of [the] object were several windows extending from [the] top to [the] near edge of [the] object; midsection of [the] ship had a blue light which gradually changed to different shades. There was a large amount of activity and movement in the midsection which could not be identified as being human as [but?] it did not have a regular pattern of movement such as mechanical objects would make in the blue light. There were no windows, doors, portholes, vents, seams, etc., visible to [the] observer in [the] rear section of object or under the object (viewed at time of ascent). Another identifiable feature was that along the outer edge of [the] object, there were a series of propellers about six



Drawing of an airship from 1896 California newspaper.



William Squyres' UFO from Project Blue Book Special Report 14.

to seven inches in diameter, spaced closely together[;] these propellers were mounted on a bracket so they revolved in a horizontal plane along the edge of the object. These propellers were revolving at a high rate.

"[Squyres] heard a deep throbbing sound coming from the object. When the object started its ascent, it emitted a sound like a large covey of quail starting to fly at one time. . . . [T]he grass was moving under the object when it was hovering" (Gross, 1986).

This incident could as easily have occurred in 1897 as in 1952. Everything here has an antecedent in earlier airship sightings: the occupant staring forward, the activity inside the craft, the propellers, the windows, the sounds. Presumably, if Squyres had seen it a few hours earlier, it would have been flashing a searchlight. For further evidence of the link between the late-19th-Century airship and this mid-20th-Century UFO, compare Blue Book's sketch based on Squyres' description with a drawing done 56 years earlier of an airship seen over California.

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EDITORIAL — *continued from page 3*

seemingly intelligent behavior such UFOs have traditionally exhibited. There was a time when those who wanted to know what was going on listened to what witnesses reported instead of telling them what they experienced. Not that they failed to appreciate the occasional fallibility of perception; of course they understood that. But they also understood, as do all who depend on eyes and ears to get them across the street, that perception can usually be depended upon to record experience accurately enough for practical purposes and even, as scientists have found in any number of instances, scientific ones as well. After all, meteorites *are* stones falling from the sky, not (as an earlier generation's psychosocial hypothesis had it) lightning striking earthbound stones as filtered through the naive misperceptions of superstitious peasants conditioned to believe in magical events. And, moreover (an obvious point but one whose significance seems to have eluded just about everyone), most identifications of UFOs can be made *from witnesses' descriptions alone*.

In short order (in mid-June, to be specific) Kevin Randle and Don Schmitt's long-awaited *UFO Crash at Roswell* will be out. It records the most thoroughly investigated, the most completely documented event in the history of ufology. The Roswell incident is, of course, also the most important case of all. As its secrets are unraveled (and the investigation continues), ufology's big questions, the ones that brought our field into being in the first place, are being answered: What are UFOs? Who pilots them? What does officialdom know, and when did it know it? Those whose interpretation of the UFO phenomenon is based in empirical evidence will rejoice as that heretofore unkillable canard, that UFO research has made no progress in four decades, is disposed of once and for all.

Yet, as no one could have predicted four decades ago, the last thing many ufologists of the 1990s want to hear is any of the above. One influential figure in the anti-ETI camp candidly acknowledges he would be "disappointed" if UFOs turned out to be spacecraft. Perhaps this says something about how jaded some of us have become, or how alluring a metaphysical approach is to some. Another theorist of a militantly New Age disposition seeks justification in geophysics, or his version of geophysics, for a nature-based metaphysics with which he has managed to link the UFO phenomenon, or his version of it—a version those outside the faith may fail to recognize and that can be sustained only by wholesale dismissal of witness testimony and unrelenting condemnation of all who presume to find meaning in the mass of contrary evidence. Other ufologists, including some good friends of ours, are now trumpeting something called "plasma vortexes" as the solution not just to UFOs (a mystery no longer, at least one book has already assured us) but to just about everything else you can imagine. It is astonishing that such views, remarkable

chiefly for the legions of questions they manage to beg, should be embraced so enthusiastically when their irrelevance has never been more apparent.

Cynicism, intellectual timidity, religious commitment, fear, a desire (surely an understandable one) to maintain the comforting illusion that we live safe, unseen, and unviolated out in the galactic provinces—what chance does evidence of an unsettling, even disturbing claim have in the face of these? As the Roswell saga unfolds, we will see these human foibles in abundance. One would like Roswell's critics to surprise us with something other than sweeping denunciations or invented "facts," which by now, having long since lost their capacity to surprise, are only dismayingly familiar. We are unlikely to hear anything else until we demand of our critics what we demand of ourselves: that our beliefs be grounded in what we can reasonably demonstrate to be true. If critics cannot provide us with this much, the debate is already over.

In the days ahead we are going to find out how relevant investigation and documentation are to current ufology. At the very least we must insist, if the debate is to be kept honest, that claims be *referenced*—in other words, demonstrably not made up on the spot. Critics must exhibit the same meticulous concern for factual accuracy and logical coherence that Roswell proponents have shown over and over again.—*Jerome Clark*

Abduction—*continued from page 6*

come to orgasm merely by thinking of having sex. So, yes, these recollections could be fantasies.

What the FPP cannot account for is the confirmation by Rachael that on the night of one of Susan's abductions she saw a ball of light enter the room. Moreover, two weeks prior to my writing this article, Susan revisited the dentist for the first time in 10 years and in the course of treatment had an x-ray taken of her upper gums. I have spoken with the dentist, who confirms that this x-ray shows two unusual straight metal-looking pieces in either her upper gum or bone, beneath her nostrils. He tells me he has never seen anything like them before and cannot explain them in terms of any dental treatment with which he is familiar. This x-ray is now in my possession and I am investigating. ■

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Blue Book—continued from page 12

preoccupied with whatever had occurred earlier that day. Of course Wright-Patterson housed other projects than those under the Foreign Technology Division.

But Hynek was working for FTD. Researcher Brian Parks has recently obtained, through the Freedom of Information Act, Hynek's record of employment as FTD consultant from 1970 to 1974. He worked only a few days each year, but it was an ongoing consultancy, an executive appointment, beginning in April 1970, less than six months after Blue Book's official closure. Was this work related to UFOs? At this point we still do not know.

On December 26, 1976, in the front third-floor office of the Hynek home in Evanston, Illinois, Hynek and I were talking theory as we had so many times over the years. Hynek was not a man to make bold statements, and I recognized the remarks of a man whose thinking had evolved with reluctance and deliberation over 28 years.

"It's very definitely connected with intelligence somewhere," he said, not with excitement and awe but with acceptance and resignation. ■

Debunking—continued from page 15

Russians love to read, and Russians love to dream. Food shortages will not stop them from gazing into the skies, looking for an explanation of who we are and whence we all come. As the Soviet Union opens up, the ranks of those who seek explanations for UFOs and for the riddles of antiquity expand, and the pace of publishing in these areas quickens. Countless new magazines deal with the UFO phenomenon, sprouting like mushrooms in a rain-drenched forest. In trying to bash these heresies, Kondratov, Shilik, and their ilk have their work cut out for them. ■

Crop circles—continued from page 19

long, constructive comment suggested parameters for statistical studies and an exchange of information. A comment about tourism was not unexpected but reveals a naive view of the places where circles are located, especially in Canada. As for people who enjoy being "in the spotlight," it is a fact that many owners of fields with crop circles avoid publicity and do not even report the circles for fear of ridicule. On the other hand, souvenir stands at crop-circle sites in England and Canada have been set up (and some field owners are charging admission).

The survey shows that agriculturists are less than experts on the phenomenon of crop circles. Their expertise in examining field markings, however, makes them useful sources for investigations and research. Ufologists probably have the most extensive backgrounds for crop-

circle research in terms of having historical data for comparison, but they may tend to be biased in favor of the UFO explanation. Similarly meteorologists may be the most versed in weather explanations, but they will not have the advantage of agricultural experience possessed by farmers. This all suggests a multidisciplinary approach to crop circles may be the best answer. It would not hurt to have police and other law-enforcement officials involved, either.

The survey conducted in Manitoba was of limited scope, and similar studies in other regions may yield different results. It would be best to have as large a database as possible to draw upon for information, but since the survey gathered only opinions for the most part, the amount of useful information gained for crop-circle research is minimal.

Crop-circle researchers are encouraged to draw upon a wide variety of resources in their investigations and to communicate their ideas and discoveries to other interested persons and organizations. Data about circles should be exchanged freely, especially because circles seem to be a global phenomenon. More important, researchers should not feel committed to any one theory until more data have been examined and experts in the fields of agriculture, meteorology, and law enforcement as well as local farmers should be consulted in investigations.

Crop circles *may* be explained as simply as hoaxes, but we would then be in a position to ask the sociological question *why*, the psychological question *who*, and the mechanical question *how*. If the circles (and triangles and rectangles and spirals) are caused by aliens, then we can ask what is their motivation (though realizing that we have no way of comprehending extraterrestrial logic). If the crop circles are weather effects, why have they appeared recently in such numbers? If they are a rare phenomenon, then they should not have increased so dramatically in number. If they are so common, then why would they concentrate in England, and why have some farmers with many decades' experience insisted that the circles resemble nothing in recent memory? ■

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